

Black knight in cross-checks

By C.G.S.Narayanan

The resourcefulness of black knight in cross-checks has resulted in its being used much more frequently than either the rook or the bishop. Its locus is a double one, one for the diagonal checks and the other for the lateral, which is twice as many spots possible as in the case either of the rook or bishop. Experiments on the discovered cross-checks using various pieces by leading composers dates back to Good Companion days hundred years ago. The first problem below shows three lateral cross-checks involving three corrections by the BN in a Meredith setting with a thematic key.

A.C.White
GC Tourney 1918



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Bc5! waiting

1...N any+ 2.Nd4

Now the corrections

1...Nb5+ 2.Bd3

1...Nf5+ 2.Bd5

1...Nxc8+ 2.Bd3

The second two-mover by the British grandmaster is a classic cross-checker with four diagonal variations by the BN with two

white batteries, self-pins, selfblock and subtle discovered mates.

Comins Mansfield

I prize, GC 1917



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Be4 (2.Nxc4)

1...cN any+ 2.Nc4

1...Nxd6+ 2.Bd3

1...Nxe3+ 2.Nb5

1...Ne5+ 2.Rd3

The two-mover (below for solving) by Argentine grandmaster has three lateral cross-checks

Arnoldo Ellerman

Good Companion 1921



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Memorable merediths'

Set 1...Qb5+ 2.dNc6; 1...Qh3+ 2.Ne6 dbl.ch **Key 1.Qf8 (threat 2.Qc8)** 1...Qb5+ 2.eNc6; 1...Qh3+ 2.eNf5; 1...Qxd4+ 2.eNd5; 1...Qxe4 2.Nb3; 1...Qg3 2.Ne6 2.eNf5; 1...Qxd4+ 2.eNd5; 1...Qxe4 2.Nb3; 1...Qg3 2.Ne6

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